Suffolk Construction Company, Inc.
65 Allerton Street
Boston, Massachusetts 02119
P: (617) 445-3500
F: (617) 541-2128

Project: 226052 DFCI-BIDMC New Cancer Hospital - 1 Joslin Place - Construction
1 Joslin Place
Boston, Massachusetts 02215

RFI #0-PB-123: Acoustic Louver Testing

Revision	0	**Status**	Closed on 03/17/26
To	Jensen Ying (Payette Associates, Inc. (BOSTON)) Hyunsuk Yun (Payette Associates, Inc. (BOSTON)) Jeff Abramson (Payette Associates, Inc. (BOSTON)) Jessica Hoctor (Payette Associates, Inc. (BOSTON)) Mollica Manandhar (Payette Associates, Inc. (BOSTON)) Emilio Cardarelli (PAYETTE)	**From**	Devin DiManno (Suffolk Construction) 65 Allerton St. Boston, Massachusetts 02119
Date Initiated	Feb 25, 2026	**Due Date**	Mar 4, 2026
Location		**Project Stage**	Bidding
Cost Impact		**Schedule Impact**	No
Spec Section	084413 - GLAZED ALUMINUM CURTAIN WALLS	**Cost Code**	
Drawing Number		**Reference**	
Linked Drawings			
Received From	Zachary Grapner (Island Exterior Fabrication)	**Sub Job**	
Copies To	Jeff Abramson (Payette Associates, Inc. (BOSTON)), Elisa Arriaga (Vanasse Hangen Brustlin, Inc. (BOSTON)), Emilio Cardarelli (PAYETTE), Joy Clark (Leggat McCall Properties LLC), Nathan Crowley (Suffolk Construction), Felipe Francisco (Studio NYL (BOULDER)), Emil Giordano (Suffolk Construction), Kevin Griffin (Leggat McCall Properties LLC), Jason Hasko (Studio NYL (BOULDER)), Benjamin Hedges (Suffolk Construction), Jessica Hoctor (Payette Associates, Inc. (BOSTON)), Silas Mackey (Suffolk Construction), Kevin Malenchini (Suffolk Construction), Mollica Manandhar (Payette Associates, Inc. (BOSTON)), Rick Medeiros (Suffolk Construction), Rob Morsi (Suffolk Construction), Steve Mulligan (St. Onge Company (YORK)), Chris O'Hara (Studio NYL (BOULDER)), Christopher O'Neil (Suffolk Construction), Joel Perry (Suffolk Construction), Brad Prestbo (Studio NYL (BOULDER)), Kyle Reilly (Suffolk Construction), Henry Sniezek (Suffolk Construction), Ben Stanton (Leggat McCall Properties LLC), Dan Sullivan (Leggat McCall Properties LLC), Sabrina Torchia (Suffolk Construction), Bob Walsh (Leggat McCall Properties LLC), Benjamin Watkins (Suffolk Construction), Jensen Ying (Payette Associates, Inc. (BOSTON)), Hyunsuk Yun (Payette Associates, Inc. (BOSTON))		

ADDITIONAL FIELDS

Required Reviewers		**Urgency**	Low

Activity

Question

Question from Devin DiManno Suffolk Construction *on Wednesday, Feb 25, 2026 at 06:20 PM EST*

Please confirm the following items so the testing agency can properly perform the acoustic louver testing:

1. Please confirm whether the acoustic louver testing should be performed at the typical airflow (fpm) for the unit. If so, provide the required airflow value. If a different airflow rate is intended for the test, please provide that value instead.
2. Please identify the maximum allowable noise level that the louver and custom perforated screen assembly must not exceed during testing.
3. Please provide any additional design criteria or client-specific guidelines that should be incorporated into the acoustic test procedure.

Official Response

Response from JP Connors Suffolk Construction *on Tuesday, Mar 17, 2026 at 08:40 AM EDT*

PAI 3/13/26 Response:

The Design Team recommends that prior to physical scale model, or full scale aeroacoustic wind tunnel testing, an Airflow-Induced Noise (Aeroacoustic) Design Review be performed by a consulting engineer such as RWDI. The objective of the Design Review is to determine whether the size/spacing of the proposed perforations, when combined with varying wind conditions and/or intake/exhaust airflows, will have a potential for induced noise that is often heard as a 'whistling' or 'humming' type of sound.
The Design Review shall include comprehensive evaluation of the project details to identify the potential for the typical mechanisms of flow-induced noise. These phenomena may include Helmholtz Resonance; perforation noise; edge tones generated by flows parallel to gaps between objects; and vortex shedding from objects with flows perpendicular to sharp edges. The study shall consider that airflow induced noise can sometimes be exacerbated by a combination of these mechanisms working together to significantly amplify the noise.
Results shall be reported via a brief summary report, identifying design features (e.g. a specific perforation pattern) that have potential for wind-induced noise and vibration, and level of risk associated (low, medium or high). If high risks are predicted, mitigation concepts shall be suggested.

As noted above, should significant issues be predicted, the project may benefit from additional scale model testing to quantify airflow speeds and flow directions along the façade of the building to understand where high risk noise zones are, and potentially full scale aeroacoustic wind tunnel testing to develop mitigation strategies.
Part 1.7.H.1 of Section 018316 will be amended in the forthcoming Façade and Infrastructure Bulletin to include clarify requirements this Design Review process.

Official Response

Response from Emilio Cardarelli PAYETTE *on Friday, Mar 13, 2026 at 04:32 PM EDT*

Please see attached response to RFI 0-PB-123

Attachments
RFI 0-PB-123 - Acoustic Louver Testing_PAI Response.pdf

All Replies

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Awaiting an Official Response

PAYETTE RESPONSE (03/13/2026)

Please see following page for Payette's response.

Emilio Cardarelli

RFI #0-PB-123: Acoustic Louver Testing
PAYETTE Response
3/13/2026

The question regarding Airflow-Induced Noise pertains to the custom perforated aluminum screen that sits outboard of the specified manufacturer's louver (Basis of Design: Construction Specialties RS-5800).

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